

Tegra netbook

Mobinnova to launch a NVIDIA Tegra2 powered netbook

DVDs finally!

Gateway sticks a DVD drive in their new EC14D netbook

Netbook test

importantly for many people, looks really presentable. The excellent keypad makes it a useful productive tool. If you're shopping for a netbook, put in on your "must consider" list, though it would be nice to see Acer bundling Windows 7 on it. It wins our Best Buy Award award for its overall mix of features, performance and good pricing. The 532H-2Bb was also the best performer overall.

HCL Mileap MH06

Lookit me! I'm red

The MH06 is a very appealing shade of red, it actually manages to look neat, especially with the bold "ME" apparently splashed carelessly on the lid. The lid and palmrest have been imparted a glossy finish in the same red tones and the inner lid is glossy

black. The silver coloured power button is a nice depart from the red-black combination. Build quality is good and the device feels very solid. The keys are small and feel quite clustered, even for a 10.1-inch screen. We figure the Acer 532H really leads the way in this regard. The function keys are even smaller, any smaller and you'd need to use a stylus to use them. The display is mediocre, typical of a 10.1-inch screen and the colours and contrast are below what is acceptable for any kind of multimedia work. The display although low on contrast was brighter than the other 10.1-inch displays for some reason.

The MH06 features the now ageing N270 Atom processor, which is part of the first generation family of Atom CPUs



HCL Mileap MH06

from Intel. The power hungry 945GSE platform ensures that battery life is kept at a minimum, although slightly larger battery rating keeps battery life two and a half hours, which

is respectable. At Rs. 19,990 plus taxes, the MH06 is a little overpriced, especially considering the ageing hardware. The Acer 532H-2Bb is a much better deal. **d**

Olive Zipbook x107h

The netbook with the always-on internet

The Olive zipbook claims to be the first netbook in India which comes with 3G to boot. As a netbook any computer is expected to have atleast some claim to Internet connectivity, and in this department the Olive comes well equipped.

The netbook comes with an internal modem which allows it to connect to the TATA Photon+ Internet service, which provides wireless Internet access in many cities across the country. Since the modem is integrated in the device, you do not need to purchase or install an additional USB modem. While this does save on space, it does lock you into the TATA service, as for

any other service you're back to using a USB stick. This is a factor worth consideration before you opt to purchase the device.

The netbook is quite compact with a 10.2-inch screen and is very light at 1.1kg. The screen offers a native resolution of 1024x600 which is comfortable for its size. With the Intel Atom N270 processor and 1GB of RAM, the system runs the Windows XP Home edition it comes with quite well. Although Windows 7 performed admirably well on it even with Aero turned on. The netbook also has a 160GB HDD, a 1.3MP webcam and mic, a 3-in-1 card reader and three USB ports.

While the device does

offer quite a convenient package for internet connectivity on the go, and the performance is quite good, the build quality of the device is unimpressive. The plastic body feels a little flimsy although it is tougher than it looks. Furthermore, its portability is quite hampered by the short two hour battery life provided by its 3-cell battery, although an option for a 6-cell battery is available.

Since this is a 10.2-inch netbook, the keyboard is expectedly small, however it is comfortable. The same cannot be said about its touchpad, which has some rather stiff and noisy mouse buttons.



Overall, the Olive Zipbook is a pleasant experience when it comes to internet connectivity, however its poorly chiseled looks and poor touchpad take a lot from its appeal. For someone looking for a device with an integrated internet connection which will work anywhere, the Olive Zipbook might be the answer but most others will be better off with a device which is better crafted and with the addition of an external USB internet stick.